Festschriften

H 1600

A. Background 1

B. Recent revisions 1

C. Definitions 1

D. Topic 2

E. Honoree(s) 2

Revision history 2

A. Background

A festschrift is a complimentary or memorial publication usually in the form of a collection of essays, addresses, or biographical, bibliographical, scientific, or other contributions, often embodying the results of research, issued in honor of a person, an institution, or a society, usually on the occasion of an anniversary celebration. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning subject headings to festschriften.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Festschrift: complimentary or memorial publication usually in the form of a collection of essays, addresses, or biographical, bibliographical, scientific, or other contributions, often embodying the results of research, issued in honor of a person, an institution, or a society, usually on the occasion of an anniversary celebration

D. Topic

Assign a heading or headings to cover the subject matter of the festschrift as a whole, normally without form subdivision. (The subdivision ***--Addresses, essays, lectures***, formerly used for this type of material, was discontinued in 1986.)

If the work is the result of a congress held in honor of the person, society, etc., use the form subdivision ***--Congresses***.

LC practice: Assign heading(s) for the topic(s) covered in the festschrift, following standard practices. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Festschriften***.

Examples:

```
Title: Africa in the long run : festschrift in the honour of Professor
Arvi Hurskainen.

   600 10 $a Hurskainen, Arvi.

   650 #0 $a Ethnology $z Africa

   650 #0 $a Anthropological linguistics $z Africa.

   650 #0 $a African languages $x Research

   651 #0 $a Africa $x Social life and customs.
```

LC practice:

```
   No change of subject headings.

   655 #7 $a Festschriften. $2 lcgft
```

E. Honoree(s)

Assign a heading for the name of the person or corporate body in whose honor the publication is issued only if more than 20% of the work is about the person or corporate body.

If the work contains a bibliography relating to the honoree which is more than 20% of the work, assign the name of the honoree with the subdivision ***--Bibliography***.

LC practice: If the work contains a bibliography relating to the honoree which is more than 20% of the work, assign the name of the honoree as a subject heading. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Bibliographies***.

Revision history

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.